

Contact

veenaosullivan@gmail.com

www.linkedin.com/in/vosprofile
(LinkedIn)

www.tearfund.org (Company)

Top Skills

Strategic oversight

Board accountability

Business Planning

Languages

Tamil (Native or Bilingual)

English (Full Professional)

Hindi (Professional Working)

Publications

Getting Dirty. Working with faith leaders to prevent GBV

Peacebuilding in the local church

TedXStormont Thought for the Day

HIV and the Church

Munster Cricket Board

Veena O'Sullivan

Director, Global Programmes and Influencing @ Tearfund | Strategic oversight, Business Planning

London, England, United Kingdom

Summary

Experienced international development leader with over 30 years in humanitarian, development, and advocacy sectors, including 27 years in

executive leadership. Proven track record in leading complex, values-

driven organisations through strategic transformation, financial sustainability, and culture change. A catalyst for feminist, anti-racist, and decolonising movements, with deep commitment to equity, justice,

and empowering women and girls. Skilled at board engagement, fundraising, policy influence, and mobilising global partnerships. Recognised for building inclusive, people-centred organisations, shaping culture through shared power, and representing with credibility at national and international levels.

Strategic Leadership & Governance – Executive team experience, accountable to CEOs and Boards, shaping and delivering global strategies, organisational culture change, and impact. Feminist & Inclusive Leadership – Proven track record in anti-racism, gender justice, and decolonisation. Skilled at embedding values, building transparency, and mentoring women leaders. Financial & Organisational Sustainability – Oversight of budgets >£50m, leading income diversification, donor acquisition, and sustainable funding models. Advocacy & Influence – Strong policy advocacy record with UK and other governments, multilateral bodies, and civil society, ensuring lived experience informs change. Movement Building – Founder and mobiliser of survivor and people with HIV movements that

reshaped narratives and influenced policy at scale. Global

Collaboration – Experienced at working across family federation and international alliances, aligning national and global priorities.

Experience

Tearfund

4 years 6 months

Director, Global programmes and influencing.

April 2024 - Present (1 year 9 months)

Various

Member of the Executive Team, reporting to the CEO. Accountable for the delivery of impact of all the international work across the 50 countries. Accountable for over 700 staff and 70% of the organisations budget. Host the Board Impact Committee and accountable to the Audit, Risk and Finance Committees of the Board. Lead the design and delivery of the Impact quadrant of the organisations' Business Plan. Lead the senior leadership team comprising of 5 Regional Directors, Head of Operations, Head of Influencing and Head of Programmes and Policy.

Spokesperson for the organisation.

Director, Global programmes and influencing.

July 2021 - Present (4 years 6 months)

Experienced international development leader with over 30 years in humanitarian, development, and advocacy sectors, including 27 years in executive leadership. Proven track record in leading complex, values-driven organisations through strategic transformation, financial sustainability, and culture change. A catalyst for feminist, anti-racist, and decolonising movements, with deep commitment to equity, justice, and empowering women and girls. Skilled at board engagement, fundraising, policy influence, and mobilising global partnerships. Recognised for building inclusive, people-centred organisations, shaping culture through shared power, and representing with credibility at national and international levels.

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Director, Global programmes and influencing.
July 2021 - Present (4 years 6 months)

International Director, Tearfund UK
July 2021 - March 2024 (2 years 9 months)
Various

Delivery of impact across 6 regions. Designed and led a complex restructure of the international work, including policy, institutional funding and communications. Accountable for all the programmatic and humanitarian work. Ensured the design of the Impact Framework and the delivery of the same. Responsible for over £50 million of the budget and over 800 staff globally.

Tearfund UK
Head of Asia
April 2020 - July 2021 (1 year 4 months)
Asia

Tearfund
18 years 3 months

Head of Thematic Support
February 2018 - March 2020 (2 years 2 months)
Global

Lead Tearfund's teams that provide sector support to the country teams across the world. Champion for leading and developing the strategy for Tearfund's work in Fragile States, one of 3 corporate priorities.

Head of the Incubation Hub
June 2013 - February 2018 (4 years 9 months)
Ireland

Head of HIV and SV
April 2010 - June 2013 (3 years 3 months)
South Africa

Head of HIV
January 2002 - March 2010 (8 years 3 months)
London, England, United Kingdom

Education

National Institute of Fashion Technology

Post Graduate Diploma, Fashion/Apparel Design · (August 1991 - July 1992)

St Joseph's College of Arts and Science. Bangalore. India

Bachelor of Arts - BA, Economics, Industrial Relations and Sociology. · (June 1987 - May 1990)